



Literature Review in Research

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Course Code: ICT-3208

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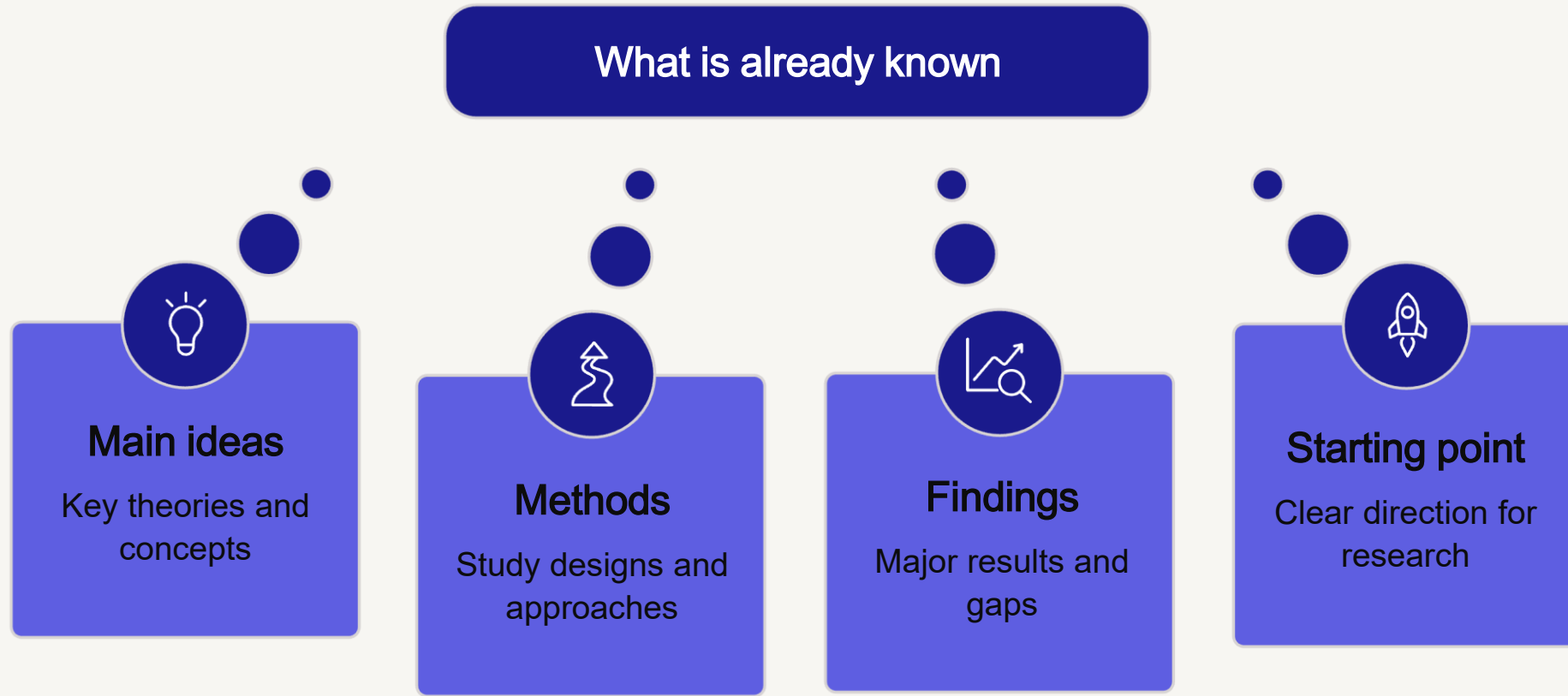
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THE STARTING POINT

A literature review studies what is already known.

It brings earlier research together—not just paper by paper.





WHY IT MATTERS

A literature review gives new research a strong foundation



Understand previous research



Find existing knowledge



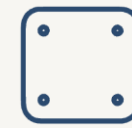
Avoid repeating the same work



Identify limits in earlier studies



Find research gaps



Build a foundation for new research



CHAPTER MAP

Five parts organize the literature review

Together, they guide readers from the review's purpose to its main takeaway.

01	02	03	04	05
Introduction	Theoretical background	Related work	Research gap	Summary
Sets the topic and scope.	Explains key ideas.	Reviews earlier studies.	Names what is missing.	Brings the chapter together.



The introduction tells readers what this review covers

A good introduction gives readers a map before they enter the chapter.

Set the direction

Give a brief overview of the chapter.
State the topic and purpose so readers know why this review matters.

Draw the boundary

Define the scope: what the review includes. Explain how the chapter is organized so readers know what comes next.

Theoretical background explains the ideas behind the topic



Move from shared language to the ideas and models that help explain the research topic.

01

Definitions

Clarify important terms readers need to understand.

02

Theories

Introduce the key theories and concepts linked to the topic.

03

Models

Describe useful models or frameworks.

04

Connection

Show how these ideas relate to the research topic.



PART 3 · RELATED WORK

Related work shows what other researchers have done

Compare each study across the same questions to make its contribution and limits clear.



Problem and question

What issue did the study examine?



Method

How did the researchers investigate it?



Dataset or study area

What information or setting did they use?



Findings

What did the study report?



Limitations

What could the study not answer?



PART 4 · RESEARCH GAP

A research gap is the missing part in existing knowledge

Ask what is missing, weak, unclear, or not tested in previous research. The gap points toward useful new research.

1

Previous research

What has been studied?

2

Limitations

What are its limits?

3

Missing area

What remains unclear?

4

Research gap

What needs attention?

5

New research

How can a study respond?



The summary brings the chapter together

Close by connecting the ideas and evidence that lead to the research gap.

Main ideas

Recall the theories and concepts that frame the topic.

Earlier research

Bring together the important studies and their findings.

Limits and gap

Show what earlier studies could not answer and what remains open.

A clear review connects what we know with what we still need to learn



Thank You

Questions?